Hello
I'm Kari Gehrke

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About

Frontend developer with 6+ years of experience building scalable, user-friendly applications, following a prior career as a graphic designer. I bring a unique blend of design expertise and technical skill to create intuitive, reliable, and visually cohesive interfaces. Passionate about solving complex problems with clean code and delivering digital experiences that inspire trust and empower users.

Experience

AUGUST 2021 - PRESENT

Red Ventures, Fort Mill, SC - *Frontend Developer*

- Lead frontend developer for **shop.energyharbor.com** and **shop.trieagleenergy.com**, delivering scalable, high-performing web applications serving Texas and midwest/northeast states.
- Built and maintained a reusable Solar Lead form widget used across multiple major platforms (saveonenergy.com, chooseenergy.com, bankrate.com, and cnet.com), ensuring consistency, reliability, and ease of implementation across businesses.
- Partnered on a full site rebuild of saveonenergy.com using React, Next.js, TypeScript, and Tailwind, with a focus on clean architecture, accessibility, and maintainability.
- Supported end-to-end rebuilds of multiple partner sites, contributing frontend expertise, writing Cypress tests for unit and E2E coverage, and helping establish testing standards to improve reliability.
- Collaborate with design, product, and content teams to plan projects, provide technical insights/estimates, and deliver user-centric solutions on time and within budget.
- Work closely with backend developers to integrate UI components with APIs and databases, ensuring seamless client/server communication and scalable architecture.
- Set and advocate for frontend code quality standards, conducting peer reviews to reinforce best practices in testability, performance, and maintainability.
- Author and contribute to documentation that improves knowledge sharing and onboarding across teams and business units.
- Partner with design teams to deliver reusable, efficient, and scalable solutions that enhance both customer experience and internal development workflows.

JUNE 2019 - AUGUST 2021

HealthSpace Data Systems Ltd, Charlotte, NC - *Full-Stack Software Engineer*

- Built and maintained clean, scalable, and testable code by fixing bugs, refactoring legacy code, and delivering new features using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Vue.js.
- Collaborated with engineering and operations teams to develop web applications for health departments, improving efficiency in data collection and form management for mission-critical processes.
- Contributed to the creation of a shared style guide and coding standards to promote consistency, scalability, and maintainability across development teams.
- Designed mockups and wireframes with a focus on modern UI/UX best practices, translating business requirements into intuitive and user-friendly interfaces.
- Partnered directly with clients, developers, and operations teams to gather requirements, provide technical insights, and ensure on-time delivery of custom software solutions.
- Supported broader organizational needs by designing graphics and promotional material, applying design expertise to strengthen product branding and communication.

JULY 2013 - JUNE 2019

N2 Publishing, Wilmington, NC - *Graphic Designer*

- Designed and delivered layouts and advertisements for multiple regional and national publications, consistently meeting strict monthly deadlines.
- Reviewed and refined team members' work to ensure quality and brand standards, collaborating closely with the Creative Director.
- Supported and mentored designers by answering questions, clarifying guidelines, and helping maintain workflow efficiency.
- Partnered with directors and clients to deliver creative solutions that aligned with business needs and brand requirements.

Education

2018 - 2019

University of North Carolina at Charlotte, Charlotte - *Full-Stack Coding Bootcamp*

2009 - 2012

University of North Carolina at Wilmington, Wilmington - *Studio Art/Digital Art*